# Presentate: Structured Themes Manual

*A guide for hierarchy-aware themes*

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## 1 Introduction

Presentate provides two categories of themes:

1. **Basic Layouts**: Minimalist themes like `simple` and `default` that focus on content without managing complex document hierarchy.
2. **Structured Themes**: A suite of themes (`sidebar`, `miniframes`, `split`, `progressive-outline`, and `minimal`) designed to automatically handle document structure, navigation, and transitions.

**This manual focuses exclusively on the Structured Themes category.** These themes share a common core API and a **Unified Transition Engine** to generate roadmap slides between content blocks.

# 2 Global Configuration for Structured Themes

All structured themes follow a consistent API pattern and are located in the `themes.structured` namespace. They are invoked using a `template` function through a show rule.

```
#import "@preview/presentate:0.2.6": themes
#show: themes.structured.sidebar.template.with(
  title: [My Presentation],
  author: [John Doe],
  // ... options
)
```

## 2.1 Common Parameters

The following parameters are supported by all five structured themes:

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `title` | content | The main title displayed on the title slide and often in the navigation bar. |
| `subtitle` | content | Displayed below the title on the title slide (optional). |
| `author` | content | The name of the presenter. |
| `date` | content | Presentation date. Defaults to current date. |
| `text-font` | string | Font family family for the whole document. Default: “Lato”. |
| `text-size` | length | Base text size. Default: `20pt`. |
| `mapping` | dictionary | Maps logical roles to Typst heading levels. Default: `(section: 1, subsection: 2)`. Supports `part`, `section`, `subsection`. |
| `auto-title` | bool | If `true`, slides without a manual title will automatically display the current heading body. Default: `false`. |
| `max-length` | dict \| none | Allows truncating titles in navigation bars per level. Example: `(level-1: 15, level-2: 10)`. Default: `none`. |
| `use-short-title` | bool | If `true`, themes will prioritize alternative titles defined via the `<short>` label for navigation components. Default: `false`. |
| `show-heading-numbering` | bool | Global toggle for heading numbering. Default: `true`. |
| `numbering-format` | str \| auto | Typst numbering format string (e.g., `"1.1"`, `"I.a"`). If set to `auto`, it respects the global `#set heading(numbering: ...)` setting. Default: `auto`. |
| `show-outline` | bool | If `true`, displays an outline slide after the title slide. Default: `false`. |

| Parameter | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `outline-title` | content | The title of the automatic outline slide. Default: `[Outline]`. |
| `outline-depth` | int | The maximum depth of headings shown in the outline slide. Default: `2`. |
| `show-all-sections-in-transition` | bool | If `true`, displays the full presentation outline during roadmap slides. Default: `false`. |
| `transitions` | dictionary | Configuration for the transition engine (see Section 3). |

## 2.2 Structural Mapping

The `mapping` dictionary is crucial as it tells the theme which headings should trigger transitions and navigation updates.

- `part`: Typically mapped to level 1 (=).
- `section`: Typically mapped to level 1 or 2.
- `subsection`: Typically mapped to level 2 or 3.

**Example:**

```
mapping: (part: 1, section: 2, subsection: 3)
```

## 2.3 Important Note: Heading Placement

To ensure that transitions and navigation work correctly, structural headings (=, ==, etc.) must always be placed at the **top level** of your document.

**Do not place these headings inside a `#slide[...]` block.** Headings nested inside slides will not trigger transitions and will cause the compilation to fail.

## 2.4 Navigation and Long Titles

To handle complex document structures in limited space (like sidebars or breadcrumbs), Presentate offers two complementary mechanisms:

### 2.4.1 Short Titles (Labels)

You can define an alternative short title for any heading by placing a `#metadata` block with the `<short>` label immediately after the heading.

```
= This is a very long section title that might overflow
#metadata("Short Title") <short>
```

When `use-short-title: true` is enabled in the template configuration, navigation components will automatically use “Short Title” instead of the full heading body.

### 2.4.2 Automatic Truncation

The `max-length` parameter allows you to enforce a character limit on navigation items. If a title exceeds the specified length, it will be truncated with an ellipsis (. . .).

```
max-length: (level-1: 15, level-2: 10)
```

# 3 The Unified Transition Engine

The transition engine automatically generates roadmap slides when your structure changes. It is highly configurable via the `transitions` argument.

## 3.1 Configuration Options

The `transitions` dictionary accepts the following keys:

| Key | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|
| `enabled` | bool | Global switch for transitions. Default: `true`. |
| `max-level` | int | The maximum Typst heading level (1-3) that triggers a transition. Default: `3`. |
| `show-numbering` | bool | Display heading numbers in transition outlines using the global `numbering-format`. Default: `true`. |
| `background` | color \| str | Background of transition slides. `"theme"` (primary color), `"none"` (white), or an explicit color. |
| `filter` | function | A callback `(heading) => bool`. Headings returning `false` will not trigger slides and will be hidden from outlines. |
| `style` | dictionary | Global styling for the transition outline (see below). |
| `parts` | dictionary | Override settings for Part transitions. Accepts `enabled` (bool), `visibility` (dict), and `background` (color\|str). |
| `sections` | dictionary | Override settings for Section transitions. Accepts `enabled` (bool), `visibility` (dict), and `background` (color\|str). |
| `subsections` | dictionary | Override settings for Subsection transitions. Accepts `enabled` (bool), `visibility` (dict), and `background` (color\|str). |

## 3.2 Transition Style

The `transitions.style` dictionary controls the typography of the roadmap:

- `active-color`: Color of the current heading. Defaults to theme accent.
- `active-weight`: Font weight of the active heading. Default: `"bold"`.
- `inactive-opacity`: Opacity (0.0 to 1.0) for future headings. Default: `0.3`.
- `completed-opacity`: Opacity for past headings. Default: `0.6`.

## 3.3 Visibility Logic

For each roadmap type (`parts`, `sections`, `subsections`), you can define which levels are visible via the `visibility` key:

- `"all"`: Show all headings at this level.
- `"current"`: Only show the active heading at this level.
- `"current-parent"`: Show siblings of the active heading (e.g., all subsections of the current section).
- `"none"`: Hide this level.

**Default Behavior:**

- Part transitions: Show all Parts, hide Sections/Subsections.
- Section transitions: Show current Part, all Sections, current Subsections.

# 4 Theme Reference

## 4.1 Sidebar Theme

The `sidebar` theme provides a persistent navigation bar on the left or right side. It now automatically displays the presentation title at the top of the bar for better branding.

### 4.1.1 Theme Parameters

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| `side` | string | `"left"` or `"right"`. Default: `"left"`. |
| `width` | ratio | Width of the sidebar. Default: `22%`. |
| `sidebar-color` | color | Background color of the sidebar. |
| `main-color` | color | Background color of the content area. Default: `white`. |
| `active-color` | color | Highlight color for the current item in the sidebar. |
| `logo` | content | An image or shape to display in the sidebar above the title. |
| `logo-position` | string | `"top"` or `"bottom"`. Default: `"top"`. |
| `outline-options` | dictionary | See “Outline Configuration” below. Customizes visibility, spacing, and styling. |

#### 4.1.1.1 Outline Configuration

The `outline-options` dictionary allows fine-grained control over the sidebar navigation menu. It merges with the theme defaults to customize the `progressive-outline` component.

| | |
|---|---|
| `level-{n}-mode` | Visibility for level `n` (1-3). Options: `"all"`, `"current"`, `"current-parent"`, `"none"`. |
| `spacing` | Dictionary for layout. Keys include `indent-{n}` (e.g., `indent-2`) and `v-between-{prev}-{curr}` (e.g., `v-between-1-2`) defining vertical gaps between specific level transitions. |
| `text-styles` | Dictionary defining font styles. Keys: `level-{n}` containing sub-keys `active`, `inactive`, `completed` (each accepting text parameters like `fill`, `weight`). |
| `match-page-only` | Bool. If `true` (default), the outline highlights only the heading exactly on the current page. If `false`, it maintains the highlight on the current logical section even on subsequent slides. |

## 4.2 Miniframes Theme

Inspired by the Beamer Berlin theme, it uses dots to show progress within sections. It features a specific separator `|` when three levels of hierarchy are used. It fully supports `max-length` truncation and `<short>` titles for its section names.

### 4.2.1 Navigation Dictionary

The `navigation` parameter is a dictionary containing:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| `position` | string | `"top"` or `"bottom"`. Default: `"top"`. |
| `style` | string | `"compact"` (one row) or `"grid"` (one row per subsection). |
| `marker-shape` | string | `"circle"` or `"square"`. |
| `marker-size` | length | Size of the dots. Default: `4pt`. |
| `fill` | color | Color of the navigation bar block. |
| `show-level1-titles` | bool | Show names of sections in the bar. Default: `true`. |

## 4.3 Split Theme

Features a horizontal header divided into two contrasting areas for Section and Subsection titles. It also supports `max-length` and `<short>` titles for both blocks.

### 4.3.1 Theme Parameters

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| `primary` | color | Background color for the Section block. |
| `secondary` | color | Background color for the Subsection block. |
| `navigation-style` | string | `"all"` (show all siblings) or `"current"`. |
| `header-columns` | tuple | Width ratios for the header blocks. Default: `(1fr, 1fr)`. |
| `section-align` | alignment | Horizontal alignment for section text. Default: `right`. |

## 4.4 Progressive Outline Theme

A clean theme focused on document progression with a breadcrumb-style header. It supports dynamic fil-d'ariane based on the active `mapping`, and automatically integrates `max-length` and short titles.

### 4.4.1 Theme Parameters

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| `header` | content \| auto | Override the top breadcrumb navigation. |
| `footer` | content \| auto | Override the bottom page number area. |

## 4.5 Minimal Theme

A content-first theme with zero distractions. It has no persistent headers or sidebars, providing the maximum possible area for your content while still supporting automatic roadmap transitions.

It features a discrete breadcrumb-style navigation in the footer by default, providing a sense of progression without cluttering the slide.

### 4.5.1 Theme Parameters

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| `header` | content \| none | Optional header content. Default: `none`. |
| `footer` | content \| auto | Optional footer content. Displays a breadcrumb navigation with author and page number by default. |

# 5 Hooks API

If you need to generate a transition slide that doesn't fit the roadmap pattern (e.g., a full-page image), use hooks. They take precedence over the transition engine.

- `on-part-change(heading)`
- `on-section-change(heading)`
- `on-subsection-change(heading)`

**Example:**

```
#show: template.with(
  on-section-change: (h) => {
    empty-slide(fill: black)[
      #set align(center + horizon)
      #text(white, size: 2em)[Next Chapter: #h.body]
    ]
  }
)
```